

Off The Record

KODAK SAFETY FILM

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Archives Association of Ontario

Volume 35, Number 3

Summer 2019

ISSN 2370-1099

Table of Contents

Message from the Editor	3
Message from the President	5
Member Spotlight: Mary Kosta	6
2019 AAO Award Winners	8
Planning for the AAO's Future	12
AAO Stats Dashboard	15
Caring for the Medical Artifacts of St. Joseph's	16
Moving to Modular Digital Preservation	
Workstations	18
A Workflow for Google Suite-based Digital	
Archives	21
Making Use of My Training in History: My Career	
as an Investigative Researcher	23
2019 Conference Sponsors	27
Submission Information	28

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On the Cover

Nothing says summer more than a bunch of cows attempting to cool off in the shade of a tree. This image is from a 1955 series of photographs called "Farm Feature" in the Kitchener-Waterloo Record Photographic Negative Collection of the University of Waterloo Library's Special Collections and Archives. Image no. GA68-55-7157-8. Thanks to Nick Richbell for permission to feature it.

About Us

The Archives Association of Ontario (AAO) was established in 1993 as a result of



the amalgamation of the Ontario Association of Archivists and the Ontario Council of Archives. It is a network of archives and archivists providing programs, education, advocacy and shared knowledge, consisting of approximately 300 members.

The AAO promotes the development of a co-operative system of archives in Ontario by:

- Advocating on behalf of Ontario's archival community to the government of Ontario, local government and other provincial institutions in order to advance archival practice and promote the value of archives
- Promoting professional standards, procedures and practices among archival repositories
- Facilitating archival communication and cooperation among institutions, users and sponsors
- Providing leadership through communication and co-operation with individuals, groups and associations interested in the preservation and use of Ontario's documentary heritage

Additionally, the AAO offers a number of different services to its members. Please visit <http://aao-archivists.ca/Services> to learn more.

Message from the Editor

by Grant Hurley

By now, I'm certain that many archivists will have heard of the 2008 fire that destroyed hundreds of thousands of master recordings owned by Universal Music Group that were stored in a warehouse on a studio lot in Hollywood. Details of the fire emerged only recently [thanks to reporting in *The New York Times*](#). Since the article was published, a number of musicians impacted, including the estates of Tupac Shakur and Tom Petty, have filed suit to recover damages. Master recordings represent significant potential lost revenue in the form of remasters and previously-unreleased tracks, and it is clear that the company did not keep these recordings with due care. UMG had initially downplayed the extent of the damage in public and has not been transparent about what was lost, but the article estimates that an immense amount of musical heritage was destroyed. A small, partial list is depressing enough: recordings of jazz greats like Louis Armstrong, John Coltrane and Ella Fitzgerald, blues musicians like Muddy Waters and Howlin' Wolf, and folk and rock musicians from Joni Mitchell to Aerosmith. The lengthy article on the fire in *The New York Times* is worthy reading for archivists. It is rare that journalists cover archival issues with such nuance and depth, and in this case, the author Jody Rosen makes some arguments that will be of great interest to readers of *Off the Record*.

The first of these is the importance of master recordings on tape. Rosen makes a compelling argument to retain original masters as they represent the most direct evidence

of the recorded moment—the master tapes act as a physical witness to a moment of music. Often, they contain the separate instruments on different tracks stored on the same tape, hence representing the recording in its rawest form, and the source from which all future mixes, including the copies that circulate in consumer formats, are created. He compares the tapes to paintings in terms of their artefactual quality, with the difference of course that the information on them is not interpretable to the eye. It's not clear if this kind of aura around the originary "source" extends to digital masters, though they too can be understood as originals despite their easy replicability. (A related note is that UMG appears to have stored digital masters on hard drives that were also consumed in the fire). The other point, which archivists will know, is that digital capture technologies could potentially continue to improve (though there surely is a limit to this) and therefore could continue to find previously-undetected recorded information from the tapes. These arguments caused me to rethink tapes as artifacts in their own right as opposed to being just carriers: I confess to have been thinking of them as rather neutral in the world of formats; once digitized, easily disposed of. Rosen acknowledges that tapes do not last forever, and digitization and migration is still a necessary strategy for preservation. But this is a compelling rationale to retain certain tapes, particularly master tapes, even after digitization.

The second notable argument is spread throughout the piece: that archival preservation comes down to priorities and resource allocation, a situation that will differ from organization-to-organization depending on their culture and the awareness of those

holding the purse strings. This point is pretty obvious, but I'm starting to realize more and more how central advocacy and awareness is to our work. In the case of UMG, preservation was not high on the register of priorities, and this lack of prioritization meant a large-scale, very embarrassing disaster that could have been prevented. As one source notes in the *Times* article, "Most senior executives in the record business have no understanding of what masters are, why you need to store them, what the point of them is." There is no act of preservation without risk, but keeping hundreds of thousands of extremely valuable tapes in a warehouse on a studio lot with a history of fires thanks to filming—think pyrotechnics and hot set lights—seems like a bad idea. In addition, there was no comprehensive inventory of the tapes and poor physical control. While a large number of tapes were moved offsite to a better location during the 1990s, some 150,000 to 175,000 tapes remained in the warehouse on the studio lot. Rosen outlines that this situation is not unique: the recording industry has typically had a fraught relation with its archives, frequently tossing them out or subjecting them to benign (or hostile) neglect because they represent a cost centre, not a revenue stream. This has changed in recent years as reissues have gained currency and streaming services like Spotify offer increasingly deep catalogues of content, but not enough to undo years of harm. Rosen also raises an interesting point about companies that contract storage responsibilities to third parties like Iron Mountain. While Iron Mountain is generally better at keeping things, shipping these materials offsite means archivists lose the ability to browse the stacks and make serendipitous discoveries (which are fairly common when tapes are not well labeled or documented),

as it would be too costly to do a large-scale pull from storage. Unless materials are well inventoried and documented before being shipped to third party storage providers, they could be easily lost to the void.

Who should be responsible for maintaining these materials? Companies are clearly not very good at it, but are loathe to give up control of their assets. Archives in institutional contexts are more likely to take better care of these materials, but can only do so with the appropriate resources, especially for the challenges of magnetic and digital media. [The donation of the EMI Music Canada archives to the University of Calgary](#) is a good example of a recent acquisition of an important collection, which includes master tapes, to an institution. Interestingly, EMI Canada was acquired by Universal Music Canada (itself owned by UMG) in 2012, so the company is clearly considering donating some of its assets to memory institutions, perhaps even as a result of the fire. I'm curious what made this collection a priority for donation over others, and if the company is thinking strategically about how and where their assets get donated. How can archival institutions, particularly at national scales, get the message across to corporations about responsible preservation (and its costs)? How about musicians? As awful as the fire was, it does present an opportunity for communication and greater understanding about the risks facing our valuable audiovisual heritage, and for more audiovisual-oriented thinking within our profession.



Message from the President

by James Roussain

Hello again everyone,

With the summer finally starting to feel like summer, I'm sitting down to write this submission and to reflect briefly on some of the great work our team of AAO volunteers has accomplished in recent months. It's already been over two months since many of us met in Belleville at the 2019 annual conference to debate the merits – and challenges – of outreach and collaboration. I am thankful for the opportunity to discuss and learn from our colleagues. I would like to again thank the Programme Committee (Rodney Carter, Chair), and the Local Arrangements Committee (Amanda Hill, Chair) for their commitment and tireless work in bringing the conference together. Featuring 12 sessions with 39 speakers, archival institutions—academic, provincial, national, institutional, and community—were well-represented, which is itself a testament to the theme of collaboration and outreach. With just over 100 delegates, speakers, and exhibitors in attendance, the 2019 conference was a true success. Congratulations to all those involved! The Association is only as strong as its volunteers and we are so grateful to our membership.

The 2019 AGM brought with it several changes to the AAO Board. I would like to acknowledge and thank outgoing members Tracey Krause (Past-President), Nick Richbell (Director Without Portfolio), Paul Henry (Chair, Institutional Development Committee), Emma Hamilton-Hobbs

(Secretary-Treasurer), and John Lund (Chapter Stakeholder). Though we are sad to see our colleagues leave, we are excited to welcome Jennifer Grant (Vice-President/President Elect), Samantha Shields (Member Without Portfolio), MacKenzie Gott (Web Administrator), Jessica Barr (Secretary-Treasurer), and Michael deJong (Chapter and SIG Stakeholder). I would also like to welcome Zoe Thrumston to the Board as Chair of the IDC. Lastly, a warm welcome to Katrina Cohen-Palacios, the new Chair of the Professional Development Committee (PDC) who takes the reins from Mary Kosta. I wish to thank Mary for her dedication to both the AAO and the PDC over the last number of years (see [page 6](#) for a OTR Member Spotlight interview with Mary). Note, too, that Juanita Rossiter will be staying on with the Board in her role as Special Advisor.

Speaking of the PDC and of our team of committed volunteers, you may have seen a recent message asking for new faces to help keep the momentum going. Specifically, the Advancement Committee, the Communication and Advocacy Committee, the Digital Access and Preservation Committee (DAPC), the Provincial Acquisition Strategy Working Group (PAS), and the Professional Development Committee (PDC) are looking for new members. If you or a colleague are interested, please feel free to reach out to me or the AAO Office. We welcome volunteers of every and any level of experience and the time commitment is often low. If you have never been a part of an AAO committee, it is a great way to put names to faces and expand upon your professional knowledge in a fun and collegial environment.

Looking ahead, please be sure to save the date: October 24, 2019 is the Institutional Development Committee's (IDC) Institutional Forum, which will again be hosted this year at the Archives of Ontario. We remain thankful for the in-kind support that the Archives of Ontario offers us and look forward to assembling there come October. More details on the IDC's forum will follow in the months to come.

In closing, it would be remiss of me not to again celebrate the great work of the Association in launching our organizational history book, *In Pursuit of the Archival Endeavour: The Story of the Archives Association of Ontario*. You can order your book via the [AAO website](#).

Cheers to a great summer, everyone!

James Roussain



Member Spotlight: An Interview with Mary Kosta

When and why did you first join the AAO?

I joined the AAO because I wanted to support my provincial professional organization and take advantage of professional development opportunities such as workshops and networking. I joined when I was still doing my Master of Library and Information Studies degree at Western University. I always encourage our practicum students to join! It's such a good deal – for two years after you graduate you still get the student rate.

What is your fondest memory from your involvement with the AAO?

My fondest memory was when the Congregation of the Sisters of St. Joseph in Canada received the Corporate Award in 2017. The Sisters really deserved this award for supporting an archival repository that follows best practices and meets archival standards; for their willingness to share their history with the public; and for their continuing ministry of education with library science students. Another fond memory was organizing a poster session at the AAO conference in 2015. We had ten amazing posters ranging from one done by a high school student to posters by Master of Library Science students and by professional working archivists.

Reflecting on your career so far, what accomplishments are you the proudest of?

I'm really proud of implementing a digital preservation workflow that we can use in our archives and which we built with open source software. That just feels like such a win! I'm also proud that we now have a formal practicum program in place for library science students to learn hands-on archival skills. We've had over 100 students in our practicum program, and it's improved over the years because of student participation. It feels good to be helping young (and older!) people gain archival skills and support them in gaining employment. I know the Sisters are thrilled every time we hear that a former student has found work in the field! I'm also proud of my time serving as Chair of the Professional Development Committee for the AAO. I worked with many of our former practicum students on this committee, and they, along with the other committee

members, were so dedicated and committed. You could not wish for better colleagues. And without Grant Hurley (who was serving as board liaison for the PDC at the time), I don't think we would have made as much progress. He really guided us and helped me understand how we needed to proceed successfully.

How have you seen the AAO make a difference for archivists practicing in Ontario?

I think that member organizations being able to use Archeion is huge! This is probably the number one benefit our archives obtains from our organizational membership. Besides this, the training workshops make a difference. I do hope that the AAO is able to someday secure funding to deliver online workshops. That would make training much more accessible to everyone.

What is the most rewarding part of your work?

I love the challenge of always having to learn more. For me, it's rewarding when I figure out how to do something new, or a better way of doing something. It's also rewarding being able to share what I've learned with our practicum students—and

I've certainly made enough mistakes that they have a lot to learn from me!

What do you see for the future of our profession?

I attended a conference at Boston College in 2018, along with archivists, historians and religious leaders from across North America. The theme was "Envisioning the Future of Catholic Religious Archives." The conference was timely as many religious congregations are reaching completion, due to aging populations. What was really striking

was the passion with which every historian, religious leader, and archivist, spoke about the critical importance of archives. They understood that archives keep the history of congregations long after they cease to exist in their pre-

sent form. There was a shared recognition that archives are fundamental in making sure the stories of religious communities continue to be told in a faithful and truthful way. I see the future of our profession as essential if humanity cares about accountability and truth—and perhaps in times like this—where lies have become part of the fabric of political discourse. Our role as archivists is more important than it has ever been.



Mary Kosta (Submitted photo).



The 2019 AAO Awards

The AAO Awards Committee—consisting of Jean Dryden, Matt Szybalski, David Sharron, and Rodney Carter—were pleased and honoured to present four awards at the Annual Conference held in Belleville on May 10th.

The AAO Emerging Leader Award

This award, announced in 2018 to mark the 25th anniversary of the Association, was created to recognize early-career archivists (who have been in the profession between two and ten years) whose work and service demonstrate consistent growth, leadership and promise to the archives profession in Ontario. Achievements may include involvement in professional organizations, and/or participation in relevant projects, and/or written and scholarly work. This award is intended to recognize cumulative contributions rather than any single activity.

The Awards Committee and the AAO Board were pleased to present the inaugural Emerging Leader Award to Gillian (Jill) Shaw.

As an archival records analyst with the City of Vaughn, Jill works effectively with the City's records management and archival systems to provide access and preserve the materials in the City's care. Further, she displays a natural ability to develop partnerships with local community groups through social media, exhibitions and other outreach efforts. Beyond her work at Vaughn, Jill has also been very active within the professional archives community since 2015. As communications liaison for the Professional Development Committee of the AAO, Jill developed a social media strategy that



Left to Right: Gillian Shaw and Rodney Carter

led to increased participation and awareness of the PDC's activities. She has also served as Chair and Vice-Chair of the Municipal Archives Interest Group where she led a revitalization of the MAIG website and magazine, organized open houses and AGMs, and created a municipal archives listserv after a formal study of the needs of this archivist group. When she finds the time, Jill also volunteers with the Association of Canadian Archivists in the membership and mentor committee and the Markham Fair's Demonstration Committee.

In the words of her nominator, "Jill is a consummate professional, incredibly knowledgeable about the archival profession and always eager to lend a helping hand. She has shown immense promise and enthusiasm for the AAO, and the archival community in Canada, and I cannot think of anyone more deserving of the title of 'Emerging Leader.'"

The Alexander Fraser Award

Named after the first Archivist of Ontario, the Alexander Fraser Award is given to individuals who have contributed in a significant way to the advancement of the archival community in Ontario. Achievements may range from written and visual work to involvement in organizations or participation in projects. This award is designated to recognize cumulative contributions rather than any single activity. Generally speaking, contributions need to go beyond a specific archives or community.

The AAO presented the 2019 Alexander Fraser Award to Margaret Bignell for contributions to the archival community in Ontario in the field of archival conservation and preservation.



Left to Right: Margaret Bignell and Rodney Carter

Margaret, recently retired conservator at Queen's University Archives, has a history with the province's archival community that predates the AAO, having presented a workshop on disaster planning at the Ontario Association of Archivists annual conference June 1992 which led to the production of the booklet *An Introduction to Disaster Planning and Prevention for Small Archives*. Margaret served for many years on the conservation/preservation committee of the Archives Association of Ontario, and helped to review and adjudicate CPCAR/NADP grant applications as the external invited preservation expert on the AAO's Institutional Development Committee. Under Margaret's supervision, Queen's University Archives was one of the regional depots for the Archives Association of Ontario's Thermohygrograph Program. Margaret was also an active member of AERN (Archives Emergency Response Network) since its inception, and further, she served for many years on the Canadian Council on Archives Preservation Committee. She has also served as an incredible ambassador of the archives and the conservation profession, appearing regularly in news stories on her important work. In addition to her work at Queen's Archives, Margaret has also taught paper conservation at the Masters of Art Conservation program at Queen's, mentoring students who have ended up working in institutions across the province and across the globe.

In the words of her nominators "anyone who had the opportunity to interact with Margaret quickly discovered how generous she was with her time, how patient she was with the barrage of questions that inevitably came her way, and how knowledgeable she

was about conservation and preservation in archives.”

The James J. Talman Award

The James J. Talman Award was named after the second Archivist of Ontario, who served from 1935 to 1939. Talman subsequently served as Chief Librarian for the University of Western Ontario until 1969. The Award is given to individuals who have demonstrated an outstanding level of imagination and innovation in contributing to the profession, their institution, or the archival community, or who have challenged conventional thinking about archival work.

This year, the Talman Award was presented to Robin Keirstead for his imagination, innovation, and progressive, unconventional thinking which he has demonstrated throughout his career.



Left to Right: Robin Keirstead and Rodney Carter

In 1989 he pioneered the archives and records program for the Region of Waterloo

when he became the Region’s first Records Manager (soon re-titled Manager of Corporate Records and Archives). The amount of imagination and innovation required by the challenges that come with starting a new program is considerable. Robin then did it all again when he became Western University’s first University Archivist in 2001. There he developed a program and helped design a building that provides the University with a unique range of services: archives and research collections, rare books and special collections, library book depository, and a records centre. Robin has served the profession throughout his career by participating in the work of the CCA, the AAO, and ACA. He has been an instructor at the Faculty of Information and Media Studies at Western University, as well as teaching at Simon Fraser University and George Brown and Mohawk Colleges, and mentoring students and early-career professionals. Anyone who has attended one of Robin’s many workshops and conference presentations will appreciate the imagination, not to mention the humour, that he includes. Additionally, he is always willing to provide guidance to other institutions and is a deeply respected source of advice.

According to his nominators, Robin “emulates many of the qualities that were held by James J. Talman. They both served as leaders for Western Libraries and in their communities and they are both recognized for their intellectual approach and kind manner.” And, as one of his nominators wrote, “Robin does not adhere to any archival ‘party line.’ Rather he seeks out creative solutions to problems, even if those solutions do not fit a traditional archival mould.”

The AAO Institutional Award

The AAO Institutional Award is given to an archival institution that has contributed significantly to the advancement of the archival field or community, or has demonstrated a significant level of innovation and imagination in the establishment of outstanding or model programs or services. Recognition may be granted for an individual project of particular merit or for a program that integrates many facets of archival enterprise.

The AAO presented the 2019 Institutional Award to Elgin County Archives for its innovative Green Screen Program, which combines technology with archival photographs to bring these photos to life in a very personal way.



Left to Right: Gina Dewaele (Elgin County Archives) and Rodney Carter

Time Travel with Elgin County Archives is an outreach program that uses green screen technology to photograph participants and superimpose them into historic photographs, to make it appear as if they are traveling back into their local history. Archivists

Gina Dewaele and Amber Mandich conceived, developed, organized, and delivered a series of innovative Green Screen events at local libraries, community events, schools and long-term care homes. The program has captured the interest of community members by offering a stimulating and creative activity that allows staff to start conversations to raise awareness of the archives' collections and resources, and of archives in general. This program appeals to all ages: younger participants enjoy the technology and the idea that they are "time traveling," which offers a unique opportunity to engage with a group that rarely visits an archival institution in person. Older participants reminisce about former streetscapes, buildings, and the people who used to live and work in their community. This is a creative and imaginative way of making archival resources available and relevant to all age groups.

The program was initially launched in partnership with the Elgin County Library, consisting of 10 branches throughout the County, but expanded to local cultural institutions and events, as well as being included in an intergenerational program involving a local nursing home and an elementary school. In its first year, there were nearly 700 participants in the program. The AAO was pleased to recognize the Elgin County Archives for their Green Screen Program, which combines technology and archival photographs in an innovative way to bring these images to life for community members of all ages.

Congratulations to all of this year's award winners.

All photos by Jeremy Heil.



Planning for the AAO's Future: Help us shape the association's goals and objectives

As you may be aware, the AAO has reached the end of its 2015-2020 strategic plan and so is in the midst of drafting a new set of goals and objectives to guide us into the future. We want to make sure that the membership has an opportunity to provide feedback and help us shape our new strategic plan so it is responsive to the needs—and wants—of those we serve.

To this end, the 2020-2023 Strategic Plan Working Group was struck by the AAO Board earlier this year to begin this conversation. Although the new plan won't be implemented until our next AGM in 2020, we want to start early and so are asking all AAO members to contribute their thoughts to the process. To make this easier and get the conversation started, the Working Group has drafted a set of five strategic objectives that we have posted to the [AAO website](#). We are now asking members to take a moment to review and reflect on these objectives and to offer any feedback. We will be accepting comments until July 31, 2019.

The five proposed objectives are:

1. Strengthening Our Membership (Membership Development)

Recognizing members' collective role as representatives of the Association and as respected members of the Ontario archival community, the AAO will prioritize efforts to grow and strengthen its overall existing membership, as well as supporting the interests and initiatives of its Chapters and Special Interest Groups (SIGs).

2. Optimizing Organizational Performance (Organizational Performance)

The AAO will optimize organizational performance, striving towards maximizing its stability and effectiveness as an organization. Through greater transparency, flexibility, accountability, and fiscal responsibility, as well as by improving communications among board members and volunteers, the AAO will continue to make improvements in its overall administration while maintaining the efficiencies the association has already gained.

3. Meeting the Needs of Our Members (Communication)

The AAO will continue to meet and support the needs of its membership by providing and facilitating efficient and informative communication. The AAO will effectively reach out to its membership about available resources, services, upcoming events, and other current information through its website, listserv, and eblasts, as well as continuing to encourage feedback and responding to all communications in a professional and timely manner.

4. Advocating for the Interests of Our Members (Advocacy and Outreach)

The AAO will strive to be a proactive, reliable, and responsive member of the Canadian archival community by advocating for the interests of its membership through cross-province networking, partnerships, cross-disciplinary events, resource sharing, and other outreach activities.

5. Provide Responsive Professional Development (Education and Professional Development)

The AAO will continue to prioritize professional development in response to the membership's desire for more educational opportunities. Professional development will be made available through annual events such as the AAO Conference and the Institutional Issues Forum, as well as by continuing to develop workshops in a variety of formats that reflect the membership's professional interests and needs.

What do you think? A series of more concrete activities and tasks will derive from each of these objectives which will then be assigned to various AAO committees and Board members. Did we overlook something? Please provide any feedback through the [AAO website](#).

We look forward to hearing what you have to say!

2020-2023 Strategic Planning Working Group

The screenshot displays the Archivera website interface. At the top left is the LUCIDEA logo. The main header features the word "ARCHIVERA" in large, bold, white letters, with the tagline "Solves today's archives collections management challenges, ready for tomorrow's" below it. The interface includes a navigation bar with tabs for "SEARCH", "BROWSE COLLECTIONS", "BROWSE CREATIONS", "BROWSE SUBJECTS", "CART", and "SUPPORT". Below the navigation bar, there is a section titled "BROWSE COLLECTIONS" with a search bar and a grid of collection thumbnails. The thumbnails include titles such as "Air Protection Society Collection", "Anson Corporation Records", "Brandywine Ranch", "Commission on Cancer Collection", "Council on Dental Education", "David Warren Brodbeck Papers", "Earl Burges Papers", "Fraternal Order of Eagles", "Helen Dwyer Kell Collection", and "Horace M. Sullivan Papers". At the bottom of the screenshot, the text "Archives Collections Management" is prominently displayed, followed by "INNOVATIVE, UNRIVALED" and "Purpose-built to a higher standard... yours".

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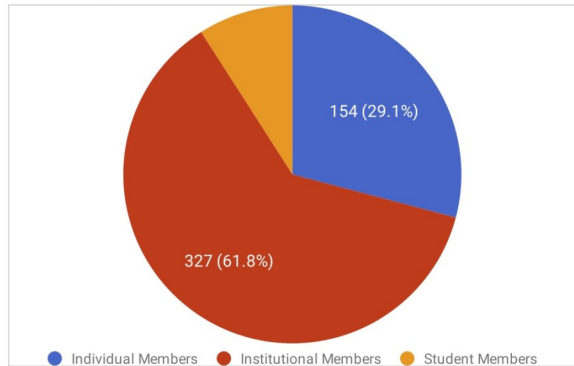
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AAO Statistics Dashboard

January to April 2019

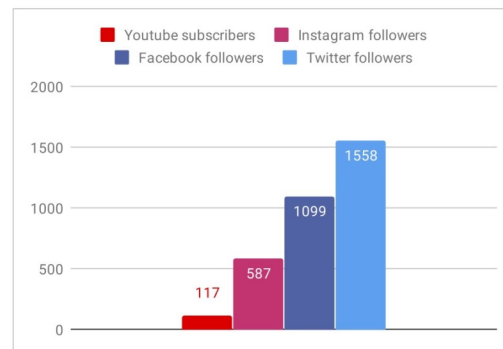
Membership



	Sept to Dec 2018	Jan to Apr 2019	Percent change
Total membership	391	529	+35

Communications

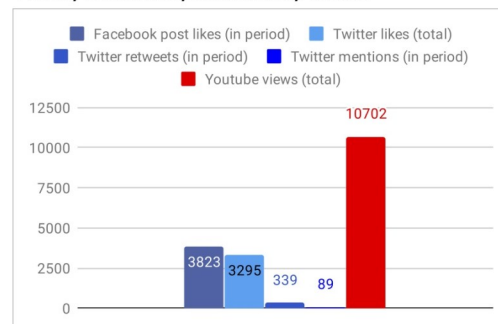
Social media followers/subscribers



Archeion

	Sept to Dec 2018	Jan to Apr 2019	Percent change
Total published descriptions (at all levels)	59,632	84,616	+42
Total contributing institutions	183	183	0
New institutions in period	0	0	N/A
Total published authority files	16,353	16,561	+1

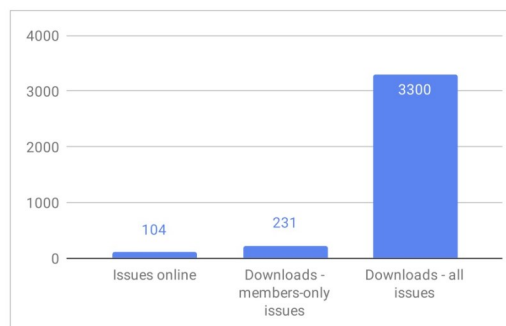
Likes, retweets, mentions, views



AAO Consultants

	Sept to Dec 2018	Jan to Apr 2019	Percent change
Archives Advisor site visits in period	2	1	-50
Archives Advisor training sessions in period - members	0	0	N/A
Archives Advisor training sessions in period - non-members	0	0	N/A
Archeion Coordinator Descriptions and authorities bulk uploaded in period	4,416	12,867	+191

Off the Record



Professional Development

	Sept to Dec 2018	Jan to Apr 2019	Percent change
Workshops in period	2	3	+50
Members attended in period	11	40	+264
Non-members attended in period	5	12	+140
Students attended in period	5	6	+20

The set of statistics above is a continuing effort to inform members about the status of the AAO's operations and engagement with services. Please note that the previous numbers for Twitter likes as published are cumulative, rather than for the period.

Caring for Medical Artifacts at the Sisters of St. Joseph Archives

by Mary Kosta

The Congregation of the Sisters of St. Joseph in Canada Archives

In 2016, our archives began a collaborative project with St. Joseph's Health Care. This London-based hospital was founded by the Sisters in 1888 and administered by them until 1993. When the Sisters relinquished control of the hospital to St. Joseph's Health Care Society, many medical artifacts and archival records were left behind. In exchange for cataloguing the medical artifacts collection, St. Joseph's Health Care has been repatriating archival records prior to 1993 to the congregational archives. In this way, the history of the Sisters in healthcare is being preserved.

The date span of the artifacts ranges from the early 1900s to the 1980s. An early artifact is a portable

mimeoscope, manufactured by the A.B. Dick Company in Chicago. The mimeoscope is made of metal and wood with a revolving base adjustable to any position. The top or drawing plate was made of frosted glass, bound by maple guide rails, and squared to accuracy. A light source was placed behind the glass, such as a light table. The user could then trace a drawing onto dermatype stencil paper to make stencils that could be reproduced on a mimeograph machine for paper copies. Another interesting artifact is Dr. Luney's autopsy kit! The collection is quite varied, and includes medical equipment for anesthesiology, anatomy and pathology, clinical diagnosis, dentistry, labora-

tory medicine, nutrition, obstetrics, ophthalmology, pharmacology, surgery, and patient care, as well as clerical functions and nursing education. While we are not certain why all these artifacts were kept over the years, we are very glad they were!

This project has been an excellent opportunity for archives practicum students to learn museum registration skills. The students who have taken part in the project have learned how to clean artifacts properly, how to apply accession



Top: A mimeoscope used for tracing drawings
Bottom: Dr. F.W. Luney's autopsy kit.

numbers to artifacts using acrylic or sewn tags, how to pad out and store textiles, how to catalogue artifacts using Canadian Heritage Network required fields, and how to photograph artifacts.

In addition, the project provided an archival description class from Western University the opportunity to describe a physician's fonds. The Dr. F. W. Luney fonds consists of records from 1907-1974 detailing his time as a medical student at the University of Western Ontario, as Senior Pathologist at Victoria Hospital, and his professional career as Clinical Laboratory Chief at St. Joseph's Hospital. This fonds contain extremely interesting records, including his notebooks, his lecture notes, his body parts and organs specimen collection catalogue, photographs of Dr. Luney and fellow classmates posing with a cadaver, and of the two-person multiple syringe apparatus he invented.

This joint project also created an exhibit for the provincial legislature's Community Exhibits Program. The exhibit focused on the



Top: Students Belicia Vukovic (left) and Sarah Boeringa (right) cataloguing laboratory counters. Bottom: Exhibit on the St. Joseph's Training School of Nursing at the Ontario Legislature, 2018.

St. Joseph's Training School of Nursing, also founded and administered by the Sisters from 1901-1970. The exhibit, titled "Nursing Nightingales: Their Lamps Burned Bright," showed how the Sisters combined a faith-based education with the scientific model established by Florence Nightingale. It traced the early history of nursing education in London, with a focus on nursing students in the years preceding the two World Wars. The exhibit was on display at the Ontario Legislature from 29

March to early July 2018.

We have found that collaboration is one of the best ways to share our resources and ensure the long-term care of these priceless artifacts and archival records, as well as providing training for students in the GLAM field.

Photos courtesy of The Congregation of the Sisters of St. Joseph in Canada Archives



Moving to Modular Digital Preservation Workstations

by **Jess Whyte and Emily
Sommers**

University of Toronto Libraries

Introduction

In 2014, the University of Toronto Libraries' Special Collections purchased a Forensic Recovery Evidence Device (FRED) workstation from Digital Intelligence. Our FRED workstation let us begin work imaging and analyzing born-digital collections held on external media carriers. However, the system aged, our processes matured, and we recently made the switch to a modular model (individual write-blockers as opposed to a monolithic workstation). Below is an explanation of why we made this decision, our costs and setup time, and a review of how that decision is going.

Prior Setup – FRED

The original solution for our born-digital imaging and analysis was a Forensic Recovery Evidence Device (aka FRED). This is a purpose-built computer workstation, and because FREDs are pre-built and come with a warranty and training, they are a popu-

lar choice for institutions. FREDs come with internal, hardware-level write-blockers. This means the content on attached media like USB keys or hard drives cannot be accidentally written to or modified. They also come pre-loaded with software to help practitioners pull content off media and do things like create a manifest or search for content. That said, FREDs are designed for and sold primarily to law enforcement and security firms, not cultural heritage institutions. They are configured to identify, secure, and retain evidence, which is not necessarily the goal of an archive. So, while the hardware was useful and some of the software tools let us get up and running, they didn't always meet our goals exactly. It was like using a butter knife in place of a screwdriver—it usually works, but it's not ideal.

Problem Statement

As helpful as FRED has been to UofT, our FRED was purchased in 2014 from Digital Intelligence and was approaching the end of its warranty. The system's performance was also suffering due to its age. Perhaps most importantly, the non-standard configuration of the workstation posed problems for both its users (archivists and librarians) and the library's IT support staff. FRED was running Windows 7 and hosting a BitCurator virtual machine so staff could access BitCurator's processing tools and a Linux environment.



The Forensic Recovery Evidence Device (FRED) at the University of Toronto.

For users, the challenges of this unique set-up were:

- They were unable to mount devices unless they were logged in as a local administrator user. This made access to UofT network resources difficult (like our shared drives, which are linked to our normal user accounts). It also created security risks.
- There were difficulties accessing attached external devices or carriers within the BitCurator virtual machine.

For ITS support staff, the challenges included:

- Supporting an out-of-warranty computer running an outdated operating system.
- Maintaining multiple local administrator accounts.
- Maintaining network security on a machine with a virtual machine, local administrator accounts, network accounts, and an out-of-date Windows 7 operating system.

We considered upgrading FRED, both its hardware components and its operating system, but we knew this would require extensive testing on all FRED's hardware- and software-based write-blocking and imaging capabilities.

The Modular Solution

Rather than purchase a new FRED (estimated cost: \$8200 USD + ~\$3000 for extended warranty), we opted to purchase

two modular Tableau write-blocker kits (quoted cost: \$4410.66 USD for both, or \$2205 USD each, including an extended warranty) from Digital Intelligence and two standard UTL Dell workstations. These workstations run a secure version of Ubuntu with BitCurator tools pre-installed. One Dell workstation and the first kit resides in the Digital Preservation Unit and is available to other units within UofT for use. It also serves as

our test case for when the second Dell workstation and kit fully replaces FRED in its current University of Toronto Archives and Records Management Services location.

When thinking about why we wanted to go modular, we came up with the following list of benefits:

- Replacement or upgrading of modular components doesn't require a total system replacement.
- Kit mobility allows for off-site use (e.g. at a donor's office, at training workshops, in classrooms, etc.).
- Does not require IT support for a non-standard workstation.
- Modular and mobile components can be shared with other departments as-needed (e.g. Media Commons).
- Increased network security.

Review of our Modular Solution

The kits arrived and we set to work labelling and testing the modular components. Everything came neatly packaged in a sturdy pelican case, with how-to guides, and in good



One of the replacement modular imaging kits

working order. However, the process of migrating from our FRED to a new workstation has been slow. The new workstation is not a true standard-issue workstation (at least not in the IT department's eyes)—we wanted a larger hard drive for staging and it's not running the standard Windows 10 installation. Luckily, the IT department has a preexisting cookbook (pre-set, bundled configurations) for an Ubuntu-BitCurator install that's pre-configured with our security requirements and permissions. There is also still the work of setting up new staff users and training them on using a fully Linux-based system. Finally, the setup also requires users to manually mount their network shared drives using the command line, which is simple enough, but documentation is still needed. Overall, the modular setup is easy to use. We've been able to lend units out to other libraries and archives in our system, bring them to workshops or classes, and do quick analysis at our own desks rather than running down to a single FRED workstation.

One drawback we worried about is the loss of perceived legitimacy that might come from not having an "official FRED." FREDs are becoming something of a standard in this realm, but we feel confident about our ability to do this work without one. We still have the capacity of a monolithic workstation, but we now have flexibility, mobility, and the freedom to use software tools more suited to our work.

Further Resources

Arroyo-Ramírez, E., Bolding, K., Charlton, F., & Hughes, A. (2018). Tell us about your digital archives workstation: A survey and case study." *Journal of Contemporary Archival Studies*, 5. [\[Link\]](#).

Barrera-Gomez, J. & Erway, R. *Walk this way:*

Detailed steps for transferring born-digital content from media you can read in-house. Dublin, OH: OCLC Research, 2013. [\[Link\]](#).

Digital Intelligence product page. [\[Link\]](#); Digital Intelligence UltraKit v. 5. [\[Link\]](#); for USB writeblocker only, see UltraBlock USB3 Kit. [\[Link\]](#).

University of Toronto Libraries' digital preservation hardware inventory. [\[Link\]](#).

Photos submitted by the authors.



A Workflow for Google Suite-based Digital Archives

by Sara Janes

Lakehead University Archives

The Lakehead University Archives is a few years into our digital archives program. So far nearly every donation or transfer of digital records has been a bit of an experiment. This spring, for the first time, we acquired and processed a set of records created and maintained in Gmail and Google Drive. Fortunately, I was able to work with the records creator through the entire process, from selection to processing.

Lakehead University has partnered with Google to provide email and other services to students, faculty, and staff since 2006. (This was the first large-scale deployment of Google Apps for Education in Canada.) While this was initially met with some con-

cern regarding records issues, it has overall been considered fairly successful: students and faculty enjoy ease of use and lots of data storage, with more reliable service than the previous locally-managed email. Also important to our story is that Lakehead has no formal institutional records management policy. The unstructured electronic records of students, faculty, and staff are distributed amongst thousands of individual hard drives, external drives, email accounts, cloud backup systems, and more. Many faculty, staff, and departments have donated records to the Archives, but each transfer has been individually arranged and negotiated. Our institutional memory depends very much on relationship building and outreach.

One of the few sets of records reflecting the entire history of Lakehead, 1945-present, is the Library Papers/Chief Librarian's Office/University Librarian's Office fonds. A finding aid for the over 7m of physical records was recently developed by Archives Technician Kathy Traynor. When our University Librarian, Karen Keiller, resigned this Spring, she and I agreed that the continuity of these records was important.

Unlike with previous University Librarians, nearly all of Karen's records were created and preserved electronically, primarily in Gmail and Google Drive. The small amount of printed documents was nowhere near a complete reflection of her work. Fortunately, we had several weeks in which to gather up her electronic records and make sure they could be ingested into our system. The following illustrates the steps we took.

1. Identification of relevant systems and records.

As always, the identification and selection of

records for preservation can be the most complex part of the process. Evaluation and selection of records at the item or even file level can take an unreasonable amount of time. Since we had several weeks to work on this project, in our first discussion I asked the UL to think about the most significant projects and programs she had worked on during her time at Lakehead. We ultimately decided that all of her Google Drive records would be considered relevant. Email proved much more challenging: like so many others, her account included personal matters, extremely trivial documents, commercial mailings, and more. We decided to export and preserve all messages to and from several members of senior administration, and all messages to and from lists of all librarians and all library staff. Certainly some interesting documents will have fallen through the cracks, but major decisions and issues will be appropriately captured. To facilitate export of her emails, the UL created a new label, searched for all messages to or from the identified address, and added them to that label.

2. Export of records using Google Takeout

Google provides a service called [Takeout](#), which allows a person who owns an account to download a set of the records they have created. Takeout allows you to select either all data you have created with any Google services, or only specific sets of records. Here, the UL selected her identified Gmail categories, all Google Drive data, her Calendar, several internal library sites created in Classic Sites, and all-staff messages sent through Google Groups. Once those selections are made, Google sets about creating a downloadable .zip package. This process takes some time: Karen's were ready by the end of the same day, but larger accounts

may take longer. The file formats that records are exported as are generally well supported and considered acceptable preservation formats: email as .mbox, Docs as .docx, Sheets as .xlsx, etc. Item-level system metadata (date of creation, etc.) is preserved. One significant issue with Google Takeout is it will not export files created by other accounts and shared with you in Drive. In cases where that will make a major impact, the user will need to download each folder individually from Drive.

3. Transfer to archivist's custody & control

Once records are exported, they need to be transferred into the archivist's custody and control. In this case, we had two .zip files totalling nearly 3 GB of records. It was straightforward in this case to use an external hard drive to copy the records from the UL's MacBook to the Archivist's HP. The decision of how to carry out a transfer (or even whether to have the Archivist perform the export of records) will always depend on contexts of technology and geography.

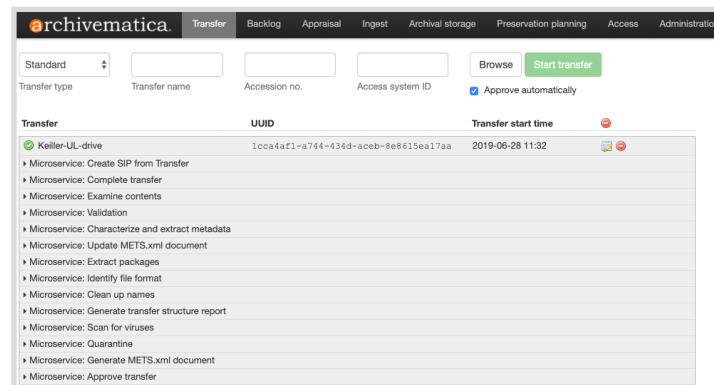
4. Preliminary processing

The files were received in a .zip format. I immediately uploaded a copy of each, unprocessed, to the Ontario Research Library Cloud for safekeeping. The .zip files were extracted, and I performed some minor arrangements and renaming to prepare the files for ingest into Archivematica. Ultimate-

ly, I arranged the records into 5 SIPs based on the system they were created in: Google Calendar, Google Drive, Google Groups, Gmail, Google Classic Sites. (This division ensured that each of the SIPs was a reasonable size for processing.) I also created high-level Dublin Core metadata for each Google Drive folder, email MBOX file, site, and calendar.

5. Ingest into Archivematica

Lakehead University is fortunate to be a subscriber to the Ontario Council of University Libraries' Permafrost digital preservation service. This service gives us access to



Google Drive-sourced files being processed in Archivematica

a hosted instance of Archivematica and storage in the Ontario Library Research Cloud. Once it's set up and configured, it's easy to use: just a few decisions, and watching for error messages.

The more complex a package is, in terms of variety of file types, the more likely not everything will normalize properly. We encountered some trouble with files associated with a Zotero library, but determined that these weren't particularly archivally important anyway.

6. Fonds-level RAD description

After that processing work, it was straightforward to write a short, fonds-level RAD description of the records, to include in our AtoM instance. This description is linked to the previous University Librarian records (for which a full finding aid is available.) The

scope and content note includes the exact file names as stored in Archivematica.

7. Future

These records contain a lot of information related to Library hiring and staffing matters, as well as other sensitive issues. The UL and I decided that all records would be restricted for the immediate future, and more detailed processing will be postponed for several years. The backlog that can be such a headache for physical records processing also can create a helpful cushion of time, making access and preservation decisions a bit easier. Further processing of the Google Drive files will require making access decisions on a folder or file basis, and incorporating the file-level metadata into the RAD description. Processing of the email account can be done in ePadd (open source software by Stanford Libraries.) It will likely take quite a lot of time to clear some email messages as potentially open, and mark others as restricted, so it's likely that access to the email archives will be only by request, and be completely mediated by an archivist.

For now, these records are preserved as well as is possible at this time. This project has allowed me to develop a workflow and how-to language that will be useful for future donations of electronic records. Each acquisition is different, but each also is reassuring that we are capable of preserving a wide variety of digital archives for the future.

Many thanks to Grant Hurley (OCUL) and Emily Sommers (University of Toronto Archives) for their feedback and troubleshooting as I was figuring this work out.

Making Use of My Training in History: A Career as an Investigative Researcher

by Ken Rubin

Some would say that with training as a historian, I never left the history fold. That's because my investigative research in filing thousands of access to information requests and by sparking hundreds of resulting stories over five decades has helped leave a bit of a trail for the public, historians and others to digest. It all started out innocently enough by liking to learn about past events in my youth. The sweeping history of the Jewish people taught in after-school Hebrew classes in Winnipeg sparked my curiosity about the details of those stories: what really happened? It became a more formal learning effort as I specialized and majored in history and politics all the way up to the MA level at the University of Manitoba. I even headed up the university's History Club among other extra curriculum activities. And yes, I considered going for a PhD and becoming a history professor. One proud and rewarding experience meant winning a small history prize while at the University of Manitoba from the John Ewart Memorial Fund that enabled me to go to the Public Archives in Ottawa in 1964, combining travel and research. But by the time of graduation, I had moved away from wanting a career as a historian. In fact, on being accepted to join the federal government into the junior "executive" officer program in Ottawa, one recruiting agency was the then-Public Archives who wanted people like me to be

records managers. Of the departments on offer, I ended up choosing to be a part of Canada's War on Poverty team as a community development specialist at Health and Welfare Canada. It was time to move on after a year of working in the bureaucracy and writing speeches for the Minister, but the experience gave me a start in looking at communities and at the government's ways of operating.

In those early years in Ottawa, one of my favorite places to be was the Public Archives. I enjoyed wandering the stacks and using the spacious reading room at all hours. And it still is a place I occasionally visit to do some background research albeit with much less direct access to materials, as the reference stacks are now closed. Still, as my interests went further into community and consumer

activism, I now realize that I had some invaluable takeaways from my training in history for my career as an investigative researcher. The one big one was the desire to learn more about the pasts of many peoples, events and countries. It was the starting place in engaging in looking at communities, comparing cultures and ideas, and delving into events. My investigative research career would have not taken off if I had not learned to read and assess original records, to seek corroborative evidence and to overcome obstacles to gain records. I

was lucky to have as a mentor Canadian historian W.L. Morton for archival research in places like the Manitoba and Hudson Bay Company archives during my during my Honours BA and MA years at the University of Manitoba. At that time in his career, it was an extra bonus that Morton had turned to looking at the threads of history, to intellectual history and the philosophy of history.

Documenting daily contemporary history about significant and hidden events may not mean checking out worn records, but it does it does mean looking at a lot of self-serving ones where officials often uncritically cite official pronouncements and takes on events. It's led me to being a transparency and a duty to document advocate, and that puts me in agreement with many historians and



Ken Rubin (Submitted photo).

their trade association, the Canadian History Association. Much of my own initial community action research was spent looking at community power structures and documenting Canadian citizen participation and differing citizen groups and movements. That meant compiling case studies, being an observer participant and using data from community groups' meetings and writing about their efforts. It also meant directing some local groups' records to the City of Ottawa Archives. It more and more became a full-time job and a life-long pursuit of opening

up government and corporate records using freedom of information legislation or through regulatory interventions. It has meant advocating and writing about the need to retain such thousands of forays into government operational records and their being made publicly available. After all, much of what governments want you to know is from official published documents and web sites.

It took the government nearly three decades to get records of completed access to information requests made publicly available, albeit only for a few years before they too unfortunately get destroyed like so many draft government records that are daily being deleted. Draft records are of immense value as they often are fuller and less sanitized, containing opinions and conversations demonstrating the decision-making process. It has meant documenting what was happening (or not) in the access to government information world, including in my open government column in the *Hill Times*, especially as governments have increasingly fought back by not releasing many records or not wanting progressive changes to broaden access and coverage. Through all of this, it definitely has helped that my skills included knowing what records are, what to expect and how hard they could be to find and gain access to.

My struggles to get records have gone hand in hand with the need for effective empathetic archival management. A case in point, that others have experienced too, were the obstacles placed in my way to get some residential school records for a northern indigenous group. In turn, the Truth and Reconciliation Commission, frustrated by the obstacles to getting such needed rec-

ords, resorted to going to court. Their lawyers argued that the government should not be allowed to rely on privacy considerations or cabinet confidence to keep documents they needed from being released and that the commission should not pay for compilation and copying. At the time I was quoted in the *Globe and Mail* on December 3, 2012 as saying of the government, "Get on with it fellows ... this is not a matter that you are going to play petty politics with. This is national reconciliation and history that's at stake."

One direct digging effort for records, your readers will remember, even helped result in the firing of the none-too-popular National Archivist, Daniel Caron. Caron's term as national Librarian and Archivist began in 2009 and some saw his push to digitize Canada's historic records as autocratic and bureaucratic, and not helped either that he was neither a professional librarian or an archivist by training. People from the archivist and librarian community felt Caron did not understand the way historic records were collected and preserved. Documents obtained indicated dissent and demoralization among the professional archivists and librarians and concerns about some of his questionable spending and job cuts. Some of the staff resented his produced code of conduct that severely restricted the types of professional activities Library and Archives Canada (LAC) employees could engage in, and that even encouraged colleagues to report on each other if high risk behavior and opinions could compromise their loyalty to LAC. Those actions pushed professional groups, from the Canadian Library Association, the Association of Canadian Archivists and the Canadian Association of University Teachers to publicly express concerns about

LAC's direction under Caron. What brought matters to a head was found in a list of contracts I obtained under the access to information act that included his personal Spanish language training expenses being taken at taxpayer expense. That went viral in 2013 in the media and House of Commons. Caron saw nothing wrong with such language lessons as he wanted to better communicate at some international professional conferences. The Conservative Minister of Canadian Heritage at the time, James Moore, who had to defend this language training expense in the House of Commons, was furious that Caron insisted on wanting to keep getting Spanish lessons and was spending more than the Minister on travel, accommodations and meals. Moore took the political decision of asking for and getting Caron's resignation.

Sometimes, as when conducting a recent search, the tables are turned inward. Such was the case when I came across a reference in Ed Schreyer's archival papers that during his time as Premier of Manitoba, he had included a paper I did way back in 1967 in his Manitoba Archives collection, referenced as being found in box 8, folder 5. I was surprised and requested my long-forgotten paper. It was sent to me in 2018 by a Manitoba archivist. It turned out to be a paper on company community towns I wrote while back at the University of Manitoba that perhaps the then-premier had made use of. The archivist grumbled to me about why donors got tax receipts for material that wasn't theirs in the first place!

While I strayed far away and stayed out of the formal historian community, I too have had run-ins and relationships with records and archives management in doing my in-

vestigative work. My pioneering research work for over five decades in accessing government records and successes in putting forward stories that go beyond official versions of events—things that historians aspire to, are highlighted on my website, kenrubin.ca. Some may call me a historian-on-the-run, or an ambulance chaser of things too contemporary. But no one has called me a thesis-ridden, publish-or-perish academic. Like it or not, the historian tag cannot be entirely dismissed. What I have indeed been doing, along with others like CBC's now-retired Dean Beeby, has been documenting daily history and significant or rarely-divulged events and issues. To do this job, you must be curious, tenuous, and interested in unfolding events. While closer to being a citizen journalist/researcher, I am aware that my access findings are used by historians and that historians and their trade association, the Canadian History Association, have been critical of the delays and many exemptions that access to information legislation contains. That, my friends, is the backstory of my staying out of the formal historian mould.

Ken Rubin is an Ottawa public interest researcher, a citizens' advocate, an author, a civil libertarian, and an organic farmer. He has filed and analyzed thousands of requests for public and personal information. Many of his Federal Court actions for freedom of information are referred to as benchmark cases. He has appeared before numerous parliamentary committees and is a columnist for the Hill Times and a freelance writer whose articles are published periodically in the Ottawa Citizen. More about his work can be found at his website, kenrubin.ca.

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June 24 for Summer issue
September 23 for Fall issue
January 6 for Winter issue
March 23 for Spring issue

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